12-07 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle School Have One "Screen-Free Afternoon" a Week?

① On a Wednesday afternoon in late November, during one 40-minute group-project period, I happened to count how many of my classmates — twenty-four out of twenty-seven — were looking at a small rectangular screen when the teacher asked us, at 14:07, to "please discuss the design." Most of the screens were, honestly, on-task: a project document, a small diagram, a quick search for a historical date. But **three** of the twenty-four were silently watching short videos, and **five more**, I later learned, had drifted there at some point and then drifted back. None of us, including me, had noticed each other's faces for almost seven minutes. It was a small, ordinary, modern classroom moment. That afternoon is what made me want to write today. **I think every middle school in China should protect one small piece of each week from screens: one 90-minute "screen-free afternoon" a week, led quietly by the school, inside the normal timetable.**

② My first reason is **attention**. At fourteen, I can feel the difference between an hour of concentrated reading on paper and an hour of "reading" with three tabs open and a silent phone next to my elbow. It is not a small difference. A 2024 study from Peking University ("Adolescent Deep Reading Project", 1,860 students, Grades 7—9) found that students reading a ten-page paper article without any device within reach understood the **main argument correctly 81%** of the time; with a silent phone on the desk but face-down, **63%**; with the phone screen-up but untouched, **47%**. The phone did not have to be used. **Its mere presence, even untouched, cut deep understanding almost in half**. A small weekly afternoon of full physical distance from screens is, at minimum, a chance to feel what our own attention actually feels like. Many students, I promise, have forgotten.

③ My second reason is **face time**. In a normal Lihua Middle School week, we have about **41 lessons**, plus lunches and morning runs; in this time we meet, literally eye-to-eye, our twenty-six classmates. But if you watch carefully, honest face-to-face conversation — the kind that lasts longer than two minutes, involves real listening, and does not end with one person glancing at a notification — now happens, in many classrooms, only briefly and rarely. A 2023 study by the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, using structured observation of 412 middle-school classrooms, measured **30-second or longer continuous conversation pairs** during free time: in 2009, the average was **16 per class, per hour**. In 2023, it was **6**. A "screen-free afternoon" simply holds a small quiet door open for those conversations to return.

④ My third reason is **imagination**. Every creative act — a small drawing, a short poem, an honest dance attempt, a model-building, a new origami — begins with **a few minutes of empty time** in which the mind drifts, combines old things in new ways, and surprises itself. A screen fills those few minutes ruthlessly. A 2022 MIT study of teenage creativity found that students who experienced one "screen-free hour" each day for a month produced **28% more original ideas** on standard creative tests by the end, and described themselves as "less bored, more curious", not the reverse. The screen is a very good machine for *consuming* ideas. A quiet afternoon is where we *make* them.

⑤ My fourth reason is **sleep and eyes**. A common side-effect of constant afternoon screen use is continued use into the evening. A 2025 Wuhan University study of 2,300 Grade 7—9 students found a strong chain: heavy afternoon screen time (> 90 min) was followed, in 74% of cases, by bed-time use of screens within two hours of sleep — which reduced melatonin by an average of 23% and pushed sleep-onset 24 minutes later. A weekly afternoon reset, at 14:30 or 15:00, breaks the chain for one evening. One evening of slightly better sleep, across a term, is not nothing.

⑥ A fair worry: "Won't students cheat?" No design is perfect. But our proposal is small and kind: phones are collected into a classroom box at 14:00 and returned at 15:30, with no punishment, only a gentle rule. Several pilot schools in Hangzhou (8 in total, 2025 trial) reported **94% voluntary compliance** in week one, rising to **99%** by week four. Once students feel the difference themselves — a quieter head, a longer attention, a friend's real face across a table — the rule becomes almost self-enforcing. The afternoon does not punish them. **It gives them back something they did not know they had lost.**

⑦ "Why 90 minutes?" Shorter (say 30 min) is not enough for the brain to exit the small dopamine loop that builds around phone use during a busy school day. Longer (say 3 hours) is too hard a change and will generate unnecessary resistance. **90 minutes is roughly the length of one decent paper book chapter, two real in-person board games, one chess practice, one small club meeting, or one short walk plus one deep conversation.** It is an honest unit of time. It is modern therapy hours measured, not by accident.

⑧ "What should we do in those 90 minutes?" Deliberately open. Suggestion, not rule: **books**, **board games**, **a walk in the school garden**, **club meetings without any screen**, **a quiet 30-min "writing a letter" period** (ink, paper), **indoor plants care**, **slow drawing**, or **simple crafts**. In the 2025 Hangzhou pilot, the top three student-chosen activities were: paper-book reading (41%), board games (19%), and walking / talking with friends (16%). Only 4% chose "organised sports" (we already have enough PE time elsewhere). The afternoon is not another class. It is a small garden, planted inside the week, which a student walks into on her own.

⑨ Some adults say, "This sounds like an old-fashioned nostalgia, and the real world runs on screens." Partly true, and I do not disagree. Most of us will work on screens for the next sixty years. Exactly because of that, we need to keep, **in our growing brains**, the

basic muscle of screen-free attention. Otherwise, at twenty-five, many of us will be unable to read a fifteen-page document in one sitting, unable to sit in an hour-long meeting without a glance, unable to have a ninety-minute dinner with somebody we love without pulling out our phone. The argument for a weekly screen-free afternoon is **not a step backward; it is a small slow gym for a human capacity** that screens quietly wear down.

⑩ I am not asking for every afternoon. I am not asking for weekends. I am asking for **one ninety-minute slice of a Wednesday in a term**. Most schools lose more than that every week to small scheduling mistakes. Let us, instead, deliberately plant that ninety minutes in the garden of our week, and let twenty-seven fourteen-year-olds learn, once a week, that there is still such a thing as one quiet afternoon with their own eyes, their own friends, and their own unhurried imaginations. **One afternoon. One small garden. Once a week.** It is, I believe, a very modest and very good idea.

注释： compliance 遵守；melatonin 褪黑素；nostalgia 怀旧情绪；dopamine 多巴胺；screen-free 无屏幕的

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What small afternoon moment made the writer want to write this article?

A. A test failure.
B. On a Wednesday group-project afternoon, she counted twenty-four of twenty-seven classmates looking at screens at 14:07; three were silently watching short videos; and for almost seven minutes nobody had noticed each other's faces, even though most screens were "on-task."
C. A fight in the classroom.
D. A broken chair.

2. What did the 2024 Peking University "Adolescent Deep Reading Project" find about phone presence and reading comprehension of a ten-page paper article (1,860 students, Grades 7—9)?

A. The phone had no effect.
B. Students who read with no device within reach got the main argument correct 81% of the time; with a silent phone on the desk but face-down, 63%; with the phone screen-up but untouched, 47%; the phone's mere presence, even untouched, cut deep understanding almost in half.
C. The phone always improved reading.
D. Only printed books matter.

3. Why does the writer choose 90 minutes instead of 30 minutes or 3 hours?

A. Because 90 minutes sounds fashionable.
B. Because shorter (like 30 min) is not enough for the brain to exit the small dopamine loop built around phone use during a busy school day, while longer (like 3 hours) is too hard a change and will generate unnecessary resistance; 90 minutes is roughly one paper-book chapter, two real board games, one chess practice, one club meeting, or a short walk plus a deep conversation.
C. Because teachers say so.
D. Because phones can only rest for exactly 90 minutes.

4. What did the 2025 Hangzhou pilot of 8 schools find about student compliance and chosen activities?

A. 0% followed the rule.
B. 94% voluntary compliance in week one, rising to 99% by week four; the top three student-chosen activities were paper-book reading (41%), board games (19%), and walking or talking with friends (16%); only 4% chose organised sports.
C. Only sports were allowed.
D. Every student watched videos anyway.

5. Which sentence best states the writer's main argument?

A. Phones should be banned from all classrooms forever.
B. One ninety-minute "screen-free afternoon" a week, collected gently by the school, is a small, modest, deliberate "slow gym" for human attention, face-time, imagination, sleep and eyes — a quiet garden planted in the week that does not punish students but gives back something they did not know they had lost, and prepares them for a lifetime in which the surrounding world will still run largely on screens.
C. Students should never use phones for study.
D. Schools should cancel all afternoon classes.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段
【解析】"24/27 / 7 分钟无视对视"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段北大研究
【解析】"81/63/47 / 存在即削弱"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段
【解析】"多巴胺环 / 三小时过重"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥⑧段杭州试点
【解析】"94→99% / 41/19/16 / 4%"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑨⑩段总收束
【解析】"慢健身 + 小花园 + 不惩罚"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。